

Opening Hook – The moment we discovered a “ghost” design system.

The Ghost System – Lost context, incomplete Figma files, and initial confusion.

Early Prototype / Alignment – Documenting legacy, codifying Atomic Design atoms, pitching the concept.

Chaos Catalyst: Monorepo Merge – Consolidating multiple frontends, discovering inconsistent colors.

Colors.ts: Single Source of Truth – Standardizing brand colors and legacy handling.

FOUC Problem – Flash of unstyled content and initial runtime approaches.

Vite Plugin Solution – Injecting variables at build time for immediate availability.

Modernizing Colors: OKLCH – Improving reasoning, opacity adjustments, and visual consistency.

Tooling Break: Library Gaps – Handling Polished, Chroma-js, and MUI limitations; custom utilities.

Storybook Converters – Live OKLCH ↔ Hex/RGB conversion tooling for designers and developers.

MUI Migration / theme.ts – Reconciling v4 → v5 and creating a unified theme for multiple applications.

Ongoing Work / Backlog – Semantic tokens, spacing primitives, component migrations, and iterative improvements.

Lessons Learned – Practical takeaways: start small, align stakeholders, embrace legacy, prioritize tooling, expect resistance, and progress through discovery.

Closing / Punchline – “A design system isn’t finished—it’s a journey.”